

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Claire O'Scuro

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12



Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures

Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive.

- Works alongside **Artie Ficial**. They usually agree on the collection and argue about the gala.
- Mentors **Reed DeLabel**, who still sends draft labels for approval.
- Consults **Chip Patina** and **Dr. Art E. Fact** when an object needs closer examination.
- **Anne E. Dote** turns Claire's research into gallery tours. Claire keeps restoring the words **Anne** simplifies.

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, extremely competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Claire O'Scuro. I am delighted to meet anyone who knows the difference between provenance and a price tag.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

You discovered that Grant knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

Your other secret

Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office.

Conversations to start

- Find out whether Dr. Art E. Fact has seen the same gap you found.
- Learn who wrote the anonymous warning note.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don't share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

- 1 *A life of resistance, written about a German theologian, shelters another secret.*
- 2 *Flowers would call this home; tonight paperwork has moved in.*
- 3 *The cars have an entrance. The secret sits above its door.*



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant demand from you, and what had you already concealed?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What hidden transaction made Grant a threat to you?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What truth did Grant want suppressed, and what could embarrass you?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What compromise in your work gave Grant leverage over you?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What did you want returned or protected?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past agreement was about to become a public dispute?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant threaten your work, and how did you respond?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I entered the preparation room through the east visitor door during the walkthrough to check the supplier names on the reference labels. I commissioned an independent review and concealed it from the board. Grant wanted the Star Bowl exhibited with a gap in its history large enough to park his limousine. He could remove me from the show. He couldn't make the missing export permit materialize by pointing at his checkbook.

IF MURDERER

I entered the preparation room through the east visitor door during the walkthrough to check the supplier names on the reference labels. The independent review would ruin Grant's announcement. I concealed it because he had threatened to remove me and replace the label with his preferred history. A curator chooses what a museum says. He wanted me to be the person who stood beside a lie and smiled.



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Wait for the host to announce the next round.



Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Paige Turner / Justin Tyme

What task or errand occupied you before the toast?

Claire O'Scuro / Vincent Van Faux / Saul D. Bid

How did you approach Grant about your papers or work?

Hugh Bidder / Tess Tament / Anya Tique / Ella Gance

When did you first enter, and what business did you have with Grant?

Monet Bags / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

Describe your errand at the private service station.

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

What physical work or problem occupied you?

Dada DiCapo / Dr. Art E. Fact / Elon Mosaic

What did Grant want changed, and how did you respond before the toast?

Sue Venir / Elle Loominate / Reed DeLabel

Why did you contact the preparation department, and how did you collect your papers?

Barb Dwyer / Frank Lloyd Wrong / Minnie Malist

What practical museum duty were you handling?

Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Penny Pincher

What did you bring Grant, and what happened when you delivered it?

Anne E. Dote / Faye Stop

How did your museum materials bring you through the preparation department?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.



Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I delivered the revised provenance folder to the private service station. The steward held the wrapped coupe while Grant criticized my label. Across the package, the printed museum crest joined neatly over the closed seam. It was still joined when the steward took my folder and I left. That was the whole of my visit to Grant's service table before the toast.

IF MURDERER

I delivered the revised provenance folder to the private service station. The steward had stepped away. Blue material lay beside Grant's coupe while I spread out the folder. Grant thought the longer ownership history spoiled the design. I offered to shorten his biography instead. A patron's title is often the least well-supported claim on a label.



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Claire O'Scuro

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Claire O'Scuro / Sue Venir / Dr. Art E. Fact

What detail on your paperwork or its packaging should we notice?

Artie Ficial / Tess Tament / Minnie Malist

What did you handle around the speech or service preparations?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What original record or material completes your account of the dispute?

Chip Patina / Al Baster / Cary Crates

When did that work or interruption end, and what were your materials used for?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Elle Loominate

What physical detail completes your account of the work you wanted protected?

Monet Bags / Anya Tique / Penny Pincher

What was on the material you brought, and what does it actually record?

Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Robin Banks

What did your access or service arrangements actually involve?

Paige Turner / Drew Conclusions / Faye Stop

Which original or retained material did you handle, and what marks does it bear?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Reed DeLabel / Anne E. Dote

What does the completed work or return record tell us?

Mona Lott / Ella Gance / Justin Tyme

What detail on the original paper or record confirms the sequence you described?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Claire O'Scuro

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I remember that crest because Grant said my ownership history should fit beneath one just as neatly. The missing export permit remained missing. I had brought a folder with a longer label; I left with instructions to make the facts smaller.

IF MURDERER

The blue material was the reusable felt mat, with a stitched museum crest. The coupe stood on it without wrapping. The missing export permit remained missing. A shorter label would not have made it exist.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.



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Claire O'Scuro

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



Claire O'Scuro

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I concealed an independent review because Grant wanted it withdrawn. The board will receive it now. My sole approach to the service station ended with the coupe still inside intact transport film, under the steward's eye. My hidden folder and my argument were real. Neither reached the inside of his glass.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I took C-17 during the walkthrough and carried it in the label cloth. Between the bells, I approached Grant with the revised provenance label and applied the solution inside his coupe beside the folder. He drank after the dome was sealed and reopened for service. I preserved the review and destroyed the man suppressing it. That was murder, not curatorial independence.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.